

MZ2POL-03: Assessment and Migration Planning

Series: MZ2POL | Notebook: 4 of 8 | Created: December 2025

Overview

This notebook guides you through a comprehensive assessment of your current Management Zone implementation and helps you create a detailed migration plan to the new Policies, Boundaries, and Segments model.

Prerequisites

- Completed MZ2POL-01 and MZ2POL-02
- Admin access to Dynatrace environment
- Access to Account Management
- List of current user groups and their MZ assignments

Learning Objectives

By the end of this notebook, you will:

1. Have a complete inventory of your Management Zones
 2. Understand the mapping from MZs to new constructs
 3. Have a prioritized migration plan
 4. Know the risks and mitigation strategies
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1. Management Zone Inventory

⚠ **Important:** Management Zone configurations **cannot be queried via DQL**.

Options for MZ inventory:

1. **Dynatrace UI (Recommended):** Settings → Management Zones
2. **SDK Analysis:** See **MZ2POL-00: SDK Management Zone Analysis Tool** for comprehensive analysis including rule patterns, coverage metrics, and migration readiness.

Entity Distribution Across MZs

⚠ **Limitation:** DQL queries against `managementZones` may not accurately reflect the full MZ entity distribution due to how MZ rules propagate. For accurate counts, use the **classic Dynatrace UI** which shows entity counts directly on each Management Zone configuration.

The query below provides an approximation of entity distribution:

```
// Service distribution by Management Zone
fetch dt.entity.service
| expand mz = managementZones
| summarize serviceCount = count(), by:{managementZone = mz}
| sort serviceCount desc
| limit 25
```

2. MZ Pattern Classification

Categorize Your Management Zones

Group your MZs by their primary purpose:

Category 1: Team/Ownership Based

- **Pattern:** MZs named after teams (e.g., "Team-Frontend", "Platform-Team")
- **Migration:** → Security Context + Policies + Boundaries
- **Priority:** High (affects user access)

Category 2: Environment Based

- **Pattern:** MZs for environments (e.g., "Production", "Staging", "Development")
- **Migration:** → Boundaries with environment conditions
- **Priority:** High (critical for access separation)

Category 3: Geographic/Region Based

- **Pattern:** MZs for regions (e.g., "NA-East", "EU-West", "APAC")
- **Migration:** → Segments with cloud region/location filters
- **Priority:** Medium (primarily filtering)

Category 4: Application/Service Based

- **Pattern:** MZs for applications (e.g., "Payment-System", "User-Portal")
- **Migration:** → Segments with service/application filters
- **Priority:** Medium (primarily filtering)

Category 5: Infrastructure Based

- **Pattern:** MZs for infrastructure (e.g., "Kubernetes", "Legacy-VMs")
- **Migration:** → Segments with infrastructure type filters
- **Priority:** Low (usually informational)

3. Security Context Planning

Design Your Security Context Strategy

Security Context enables entity-level access control. Plan how to tag your entities:

Entity Type	Security Context Value	Purpose
Services	team-{teamname}	Team ownership
Hosts	env-{environment}	Environment separation
Applications	app-{appname}	Application isolation

Query Entities Without Security Context

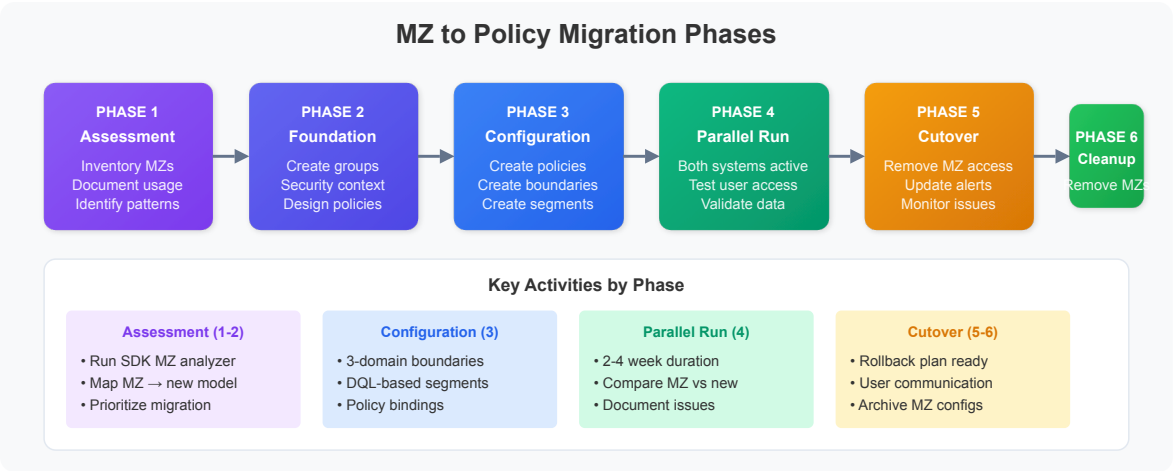
Identify entities that need security context assignment:

```
// Find services without security context
// These need to be tagged before migration
fetch dt.entity.service
| filter isNull(dt.security_context)
| fields entity.name,
        managementZones,
        tags
| limit 50
```

```
// Count entities by security context presence
// Helps estimate security context tagging effort
fetch dt.entity.service
| summarize
    withContext = countIf(isNotNull(dt.security_context)),
    withoutContext = countIf(isNull(dt.security_context))
```

4. Migration Priority Matrix

Prioritize Based on Impact and Complexity



Priority	Criteria	Examples
P1 - Critical	Security/compliance requirements	Production access control
P2 - High	Actively used for access control	Team-based MZs
P3 - Medium	Used for filtering only	Region/app MZs
P4 - Low	Informational/rarely used	Legacy MZs

Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Users lose access	Medium	High	Parallel running period
Wrong data visible	Medium	High	Thorough testing
Alert routing breaks	High	Medium	Update alerts before cutover
Dashboard filters fail	Medium	Low	Pre-update dashboards

5. Migration Timeline Template

Recommended Phases

Phase 1: Preparation

- ☐ Complete MZ inventory
- ☐ Document current user access patterns
- ☐ Create migration mapping for all MZs
- ☐ Design security context strategy
- ☐ Identify dependencies (alerts, dashboards, APIs)

Phase 2: Foundation

- ☐ Apply security context to entities
- ☐ Create user groups in Account Management
- ☐ Set up IAM policy structure
- ☐ Create boundary definitions

Phase 3: Segments

- ☐ Create segments for data filtering
- ☐ Test segment functionality
- ☐ Update dashboards to use segments
- ☐ Validate filtering behavior

Phase 4: Policy Assignment

- ☐ Bind policies to groups
- ☐ Apply boundaries to policy bindings
- ☐ Test user access (parallel with MZs)
- ☐ Document access verification results

Phase 5: Cutover

- ☐ Update alerting profiles to use segments
- ☐ Migrate API integrations

- ☐ Remove MZ-based access (RBAC)
- ☐ Monitor for access issues

Phase 6: Cleanup

- ☐ Verify no MZ dependencies remain
 - ☐ Archive MZ configurations
 - ☐ Remove unused MZs
 - ☐ Update documentation
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6. Dependencies Checklist

What References Management Zones?

Before migrating, identify all MZ dependencies:

Alerting

- ☐ Alerting profiles using MZ filters
- ☐ Problem notifications scoped to MZs
- ☐ Metric events with MZ dimensions

Dashboards & Reports

- ☐ Dashboards with MZ filters
- ☐ Reports scoped to MZs
- ☐ SLOs using MZ-filtered data

Integrations

- ☐ API calls with MZ parameters
- ☐ Automation workflows using MZ scopes
- ☐ Third-party integrations filtering by MZ

Access Control

- ☐ User groups with MZ assignments
 - ☐ RBAC roles using MZ restrictions
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Summary

In this notebook, you:

1. **Inventoried** all Management Zones with DQL queries
2. **Classified** MZs by pattern (team, environment, region, etc.)
3. **Created** migration mapping templates
4. **Planned** security context strategy
5. **Prioritized** migration based on risk and impact
6. **Identified** dependencies to address

Deliverables Checklist

- ☐ Complete MZ inventory spreadsheet
- ☐ Migration mapping document for each MZ
- ☐ Security context assignment plan
- ☐ Prioritized migration schedule
- ☐ Risk assessment and mitigation plan
- ☐ Dependencies checklist

Next Steps

Continue to **MZ2POL-04: Policies and Boundaries** to:

- Learn policy syntax and structure
- Create custom policies
- Understand default policy capabilities

Additional Resources

- [Management Zones Documentation](#)
 - [Upgrade from RBAC to IAM Policies](#)
 - [Grant Access to Entities with Security Context](#)
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